

Hack4Justice: AI Edition

Supporting MSMEs access to justice

ESPRIT, September 12th & 13th

Joining Instructions

Overview:

Hackathons (“hack marathons”) are one-time events that drive innovation. They aim to explore solutions, often focusing on solving a specific problem, or using a particular technology. For some aspiring entrepreneurs, hackathons are often the first step they take to build a solution, and form a team to build a startup around that solution. Our primary objective is to unite individuals with diverse skills and interests in a structured environment to rapidly develop and prototype solutions to identified challenges.

Hack4Justice 2026, organized by HiiL in Tunisia, is a highly competitive event designed for teams to create user-friendly, innovative justice solutions that will make a tangible difference. This next-gen edition utilizes an Agile Co-Development Model and will be held at ESPRIT (École Supérieure Privée d'Ingénierie et de Technologie). The core goal is to develop tailored digital solutions addressing universal administrative and economic hurdles faced by Tunisian MSMEs, using Regulatory AI as a core technology enabler. To facilitate this, we will provide comprehensive technical briefs and dedicated mentorship throughout the event.

The teams will present their live software prototypes to an independent expert jury during a dedicated VIP Showcase, while public sector leaders and agency directors attend as observers. We are inviting participants, divided into multidisciplinary teams of 3 to 5 members, eager to embark on an innovative and social-impact entrepreneurial journey focused on MSME support. Under our **"Bid-to-Adopt"** protocol, state entities and institutions can submit "Declarations of Interest" to test the prototypes, and awarded teams will receive cash prizes along with direct admission into HiiL's pre-incubation curriculum. The two winning teams will receive a **15,000 TND prize** each .

Objective:

Our goal for the hackathon is for the teams to primarily build a prototype of a solution, and secondly to be able to scale it and implement it. The strategic goals are to actively prevent and reduce commercial disputes to improve stability, and to greatly improve direct access to regulatory procedures to increase formality for MSMEs. We also aim to bring the Justice institutions closer to the entrepreneurs and involve them actively in the inspiration and support of these entrepreneurs. Specifically, this Hack4Justice event aims to co-create innovative digital solutions to improve services for Tunisian MSMEs.

Presentation of HiiL

Founded in 2005, HiiL is a civil society organisation, based in the Netherlands, in the City of Peace and Justice, The Hague. HiiL is dedicated to making justice accessible, affordable, and easy to understand. We put the everyday legal needs of individuals

at the heart of our mission to create fair and responsive systems. By pioneering a data-driven, evidence-based, and innovation-focused approach, we identify the root causes of disputes and scale practical, user-friendly digital solutions for real-world impact. We collaborate with ministries, judiciaries, and community leaders worldwide, proudly supported by the Dutch Ministry of Foreign Affairs, OECD, World Bank, UNHCR, and the World Justice Project.

The Hack4justice hackathon

HiiL has been working on supporting justice in Tunisia since 2012, through collecting data about the state of justice, collaborating with public authorities on how to make justice more user-friendly, and supporting the justice entrepreneurship ecosystem. Since 2022, HiiL has hosted 4 hackathons and co-implemented 2, driving grassroots innovation to address persistent legal friction. The 2026 Next-Gen Edition pushes boundaries further with a special focus aimed specifically at accelerating admin-tech & simplifying business procedures. Teams will tackle two core challenges, in the format of a 24-hour hackathon, with the following goals:

- Enhance MSME services in Tunisia.
- Empower aspiring entrepreneurs to gain in-depth knowledge of justice matters and actively contribute to creating impact.
- Foster connections between public justice institutions and innovation providers, thereby creating an enabling environment for them.

The hackathon will take place on Saturday, September 12th and Sunday, September 13th, 2026 at ESPRIT.

Day 1: The Deep Dive & Prototyping Kick-off	
8:00 - 09:00	Welcoming & Registration: Team check-ins and networking.
09:00 - 09:30	Opening Plenary & Challenge Reveal: HiiL presents JNS data insights on administrative friction. Guest speakers from partners set the stage.
09:30 - 10:30	Challenge deep dive: explaining the challenges with concrete example, mapping the relevant stakeholders, Q&A session
10:30 - 12:00	Team Ideation & Lightning Mentoring: Teams map out their chosen challenges. Mentors* (technologists and legal experts) help refine the scopes.
12:00 - 13:00	Lunch break
Timer Kick off - start of the 24h	
13:00 - 18:30	Hacking Session 1 (Architecture & UI/UX): Teams focus on user flow, backend design, and mapping out the user experience. Mentorship*
18:30 - 00:00	Dinner & Late Night Hacking: Venue remains open for overnight progress.

Day 2: The Build, The Jury, and The Matchmaking	
08:30 - 09:30	Breakfast & Team Progress Check.
09:30 - 13:00	Hacking Session 2 (Coding & Demo Prep): Teams finalize their working prototypes. No slide-only decks; code commits are verified. Mentorship*
Timer's off!! Time's out!	
13:00 - 14:00	Lunch break
14:00 - 16:30	Pitching Masterclass: Practical training on how to pitch tech solutions to non-technical public sector audiences.
16:30 - 17:30	Explain showcase plan and closing

**Mentors will be available during the slots labelled "Mentorship" to provide guidance and advice to the participants and help them craft their ideas and projects.*

What's next?

The Hackathon is the first step in your entrepreneurial journey in the justice sector. Being part of this hackathon will enable you to access a vibrant community of justice entrepreneurs (Justlers) as well as a great diversity of private community events that will allow you to build your capacities, consolidate your network and grow your project. The event features a Dedicated VIP Showcase, a professional half-day showcase for public sector leaders to scout and "bid" on promising prototypes for post-event pilot adaptation. State entities & chambers submit non-binding "Declarations of Interest" to test prototypes. Awarded teams receive cash prizes and admission into HiiL's pre-incubation program.

Day 3: Showcase	
08:00 - 09:30	Dry Run & Tech Check: Teams test their technical demos on the main screen. Welcome coffee
10:00 - 12:30	The Showcase (Jury Pitch Session): The Audience: VIP Public officials, tech hub leaders, university deans, and donors. The Format: 3-minute demo, 3-minute Q&A with the VIP Jury.
12:30 - 13:00	Jury Deliberation & Networking Drinks: Public officials mingle with the teams while the jury tallies scores.
13:00 - 13:30	Awards Ceremony & Next Steps: Announcement of the winners (prizes to support development) and the official launch of the <i>30-Day Adoption Pathway</i> .
13:30 - 14:30	Lunch break

Logistics

As mentioned above, the Hackathon will take place at ESPRIT. [Building Name]

Hiil will provide 2 coffee breaks and lunch per day as well as dinner (the first day).

The hackathon's duration is 24 hours. The venue will remain open 24h/24h and security will be present at the venue the whole time.

Hiil does not cover any other expenses apart from the ones mentioned above.

We highly recommend that you bring your laptop with you, as well as your great attitude and positive energy, we will need it!

In order to create the best possible environment, we kindly ask you to carefully read this [code of conduct](#).

Please find below the link to the location of the venue and the contact details.

ESPRIT (École Supérieure Privée d'Ingénierie et de Technologie)

1, Pôle Technologique, 2 Rue André Ampère, Ariana 2083

[Link Google Maps](#)



Contact points:

Nada Zaafrane

Justice Innovation Officer - Hiil

T: +216 55 613 096

E: nada.zaafrane@hiil.org

Asma Ezzine

Project Officer - Hiil

T: +216 22 202 926

E: asma.ezzine@hiil.org